



Policymaking framework

Policy development process and checklists

AUGUST 2025



Strategy, policy, and regulations have different functions



Strategy is an overall direction, setting the vision, objectives, the roadmap, and KPIs



Policy is legally binding guiding framework, establishing overall principles

Focus of this document



Regulations are detailed, enforceable rules implementing specific laws or policies

Following the vision and objectives set in the strategy, a policy sets binding principles that are enforced through regulations

Aspect	Strategy	Policy	Regulation
Definition	Overall direction; aligned with Vision 2030	Legally binding guiding framework	Detailed, enforceable rules
Purpose	Sets the vision, objectives, roadmap, and KPIs	Establishes overarching government principles and provides direction	Ensures mandatory compliance through specific laws
Approval authority	Council of Ministers or relevant ministries	Council of Ministers and ratified by Royal Decree (legally binding)	Issued by ministries or competent regulatory authorities, legally binding once officially published
Legal force	Not typically legally binding itself; provides roadmap for achieving policy intent	Legally binding if formally approved by Council of Ministers and Royal Decree	Always legally binding with specified compliance requirements and penalties
Examples (KSA)	Digital Government Strategy (2023) outlines the national digital transformation vision and goals	KSA Cloud First Policy (2019) mandates that government agencies prioritize cloud solutions	Cloud Computing Regulatory Framework (2018) provides rules for cloud service providers in the Kingdom

Focus of this document

Policies define a strategic framework that is legally binding

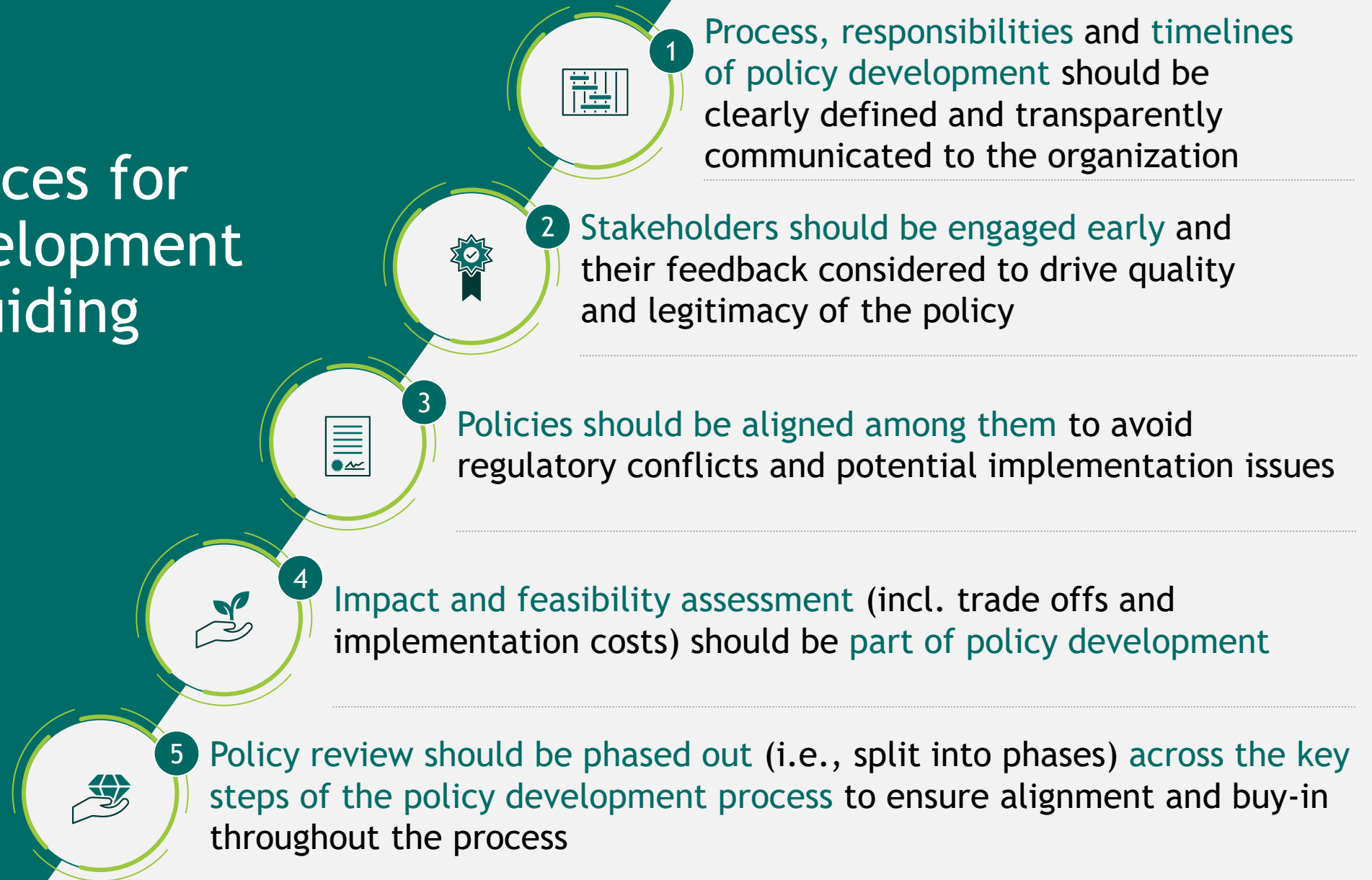
What policy is

- **Strategic directive** setting clear government intent and priorities
- **High-level document** approved by the Council of Ministers and ratified by Royal Decree
- **Legally binding document** once officially issued through proper channels
- **Guiding framework** for the development of detailed regulations

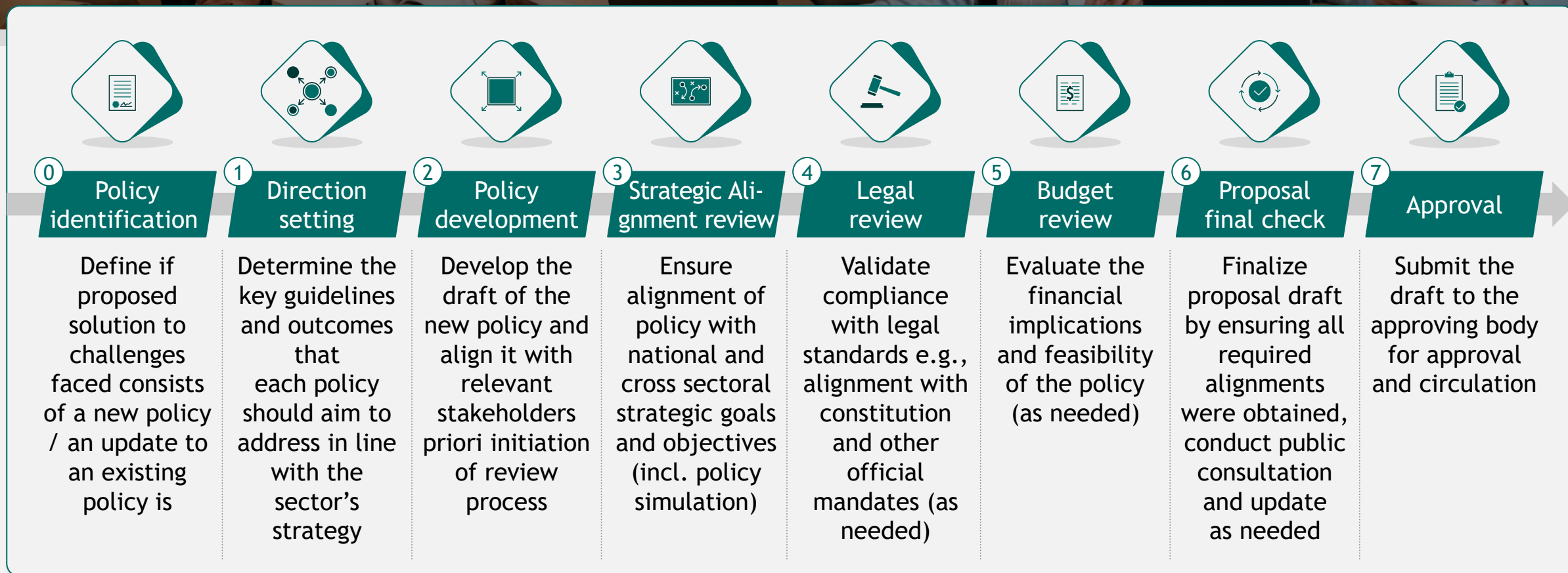
What policy is not

- General recommendation without authoritative approval
- Detailed operational procedure or manual
- Regulation detailing specific compliance mechanisms or penalties
- Standalone vision document without formal approval or Royal ratification
- Internally issued guideline in the ministries without Council of Ministers approval/Royal endorsement

Best practices for policy development follow 5 guiding principles

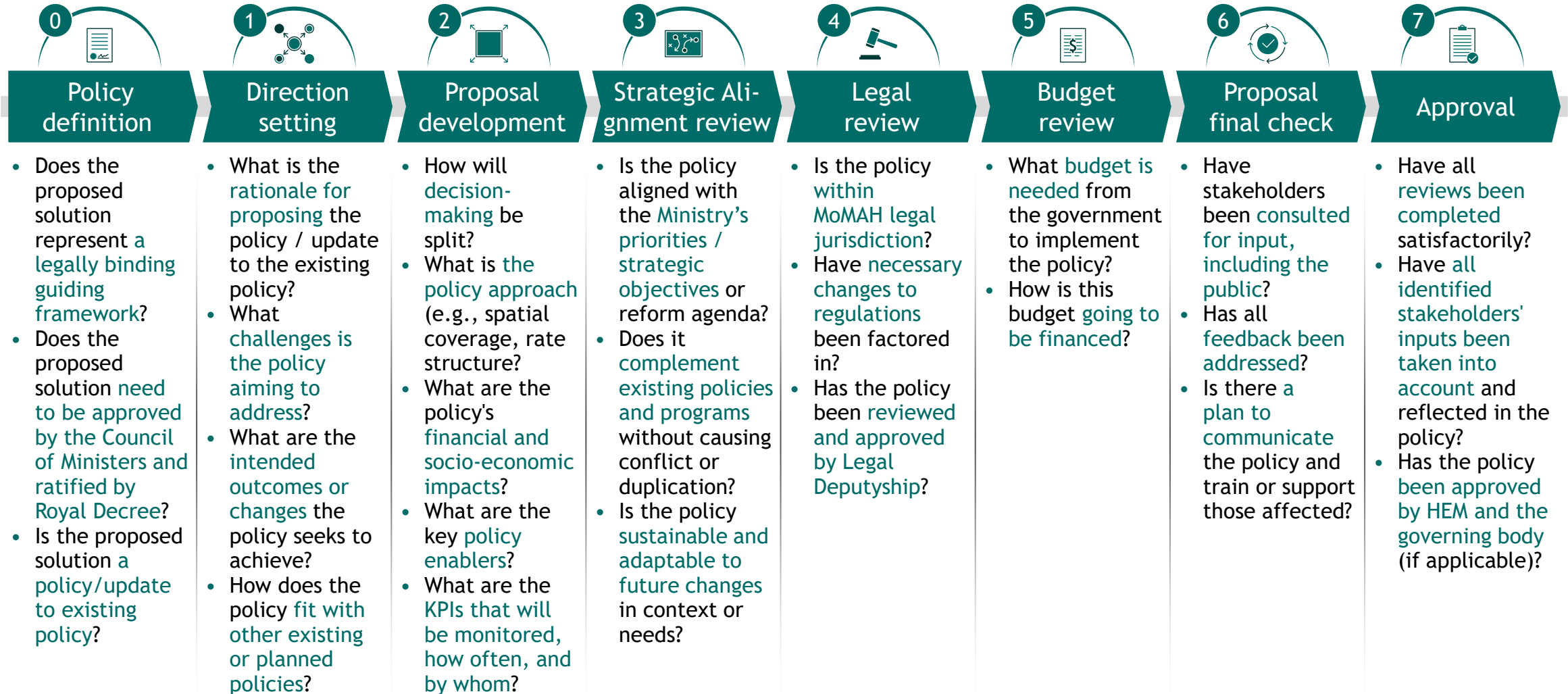


The policy development process consists of **eight key steps**

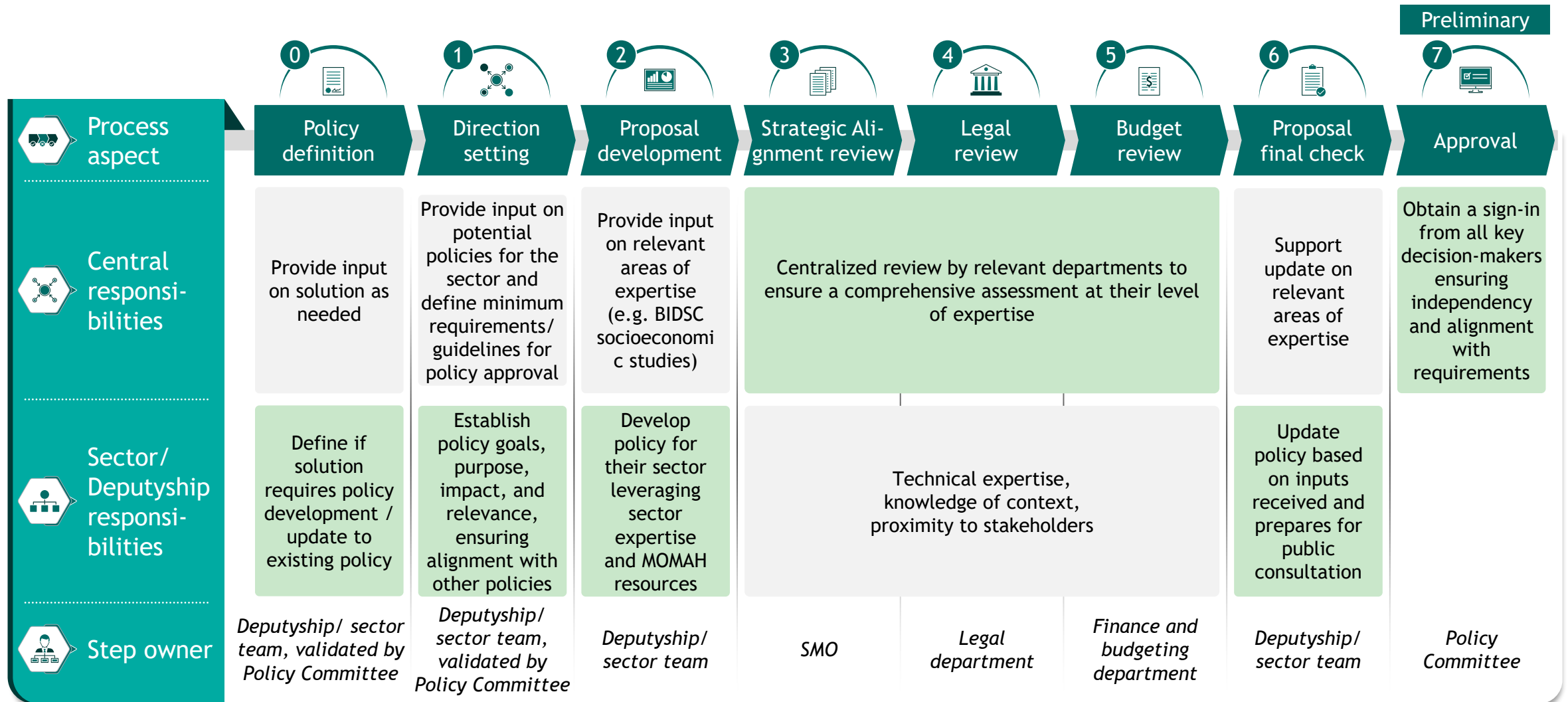


Each step of the policy development process should answer key questions

Non-exhaustive

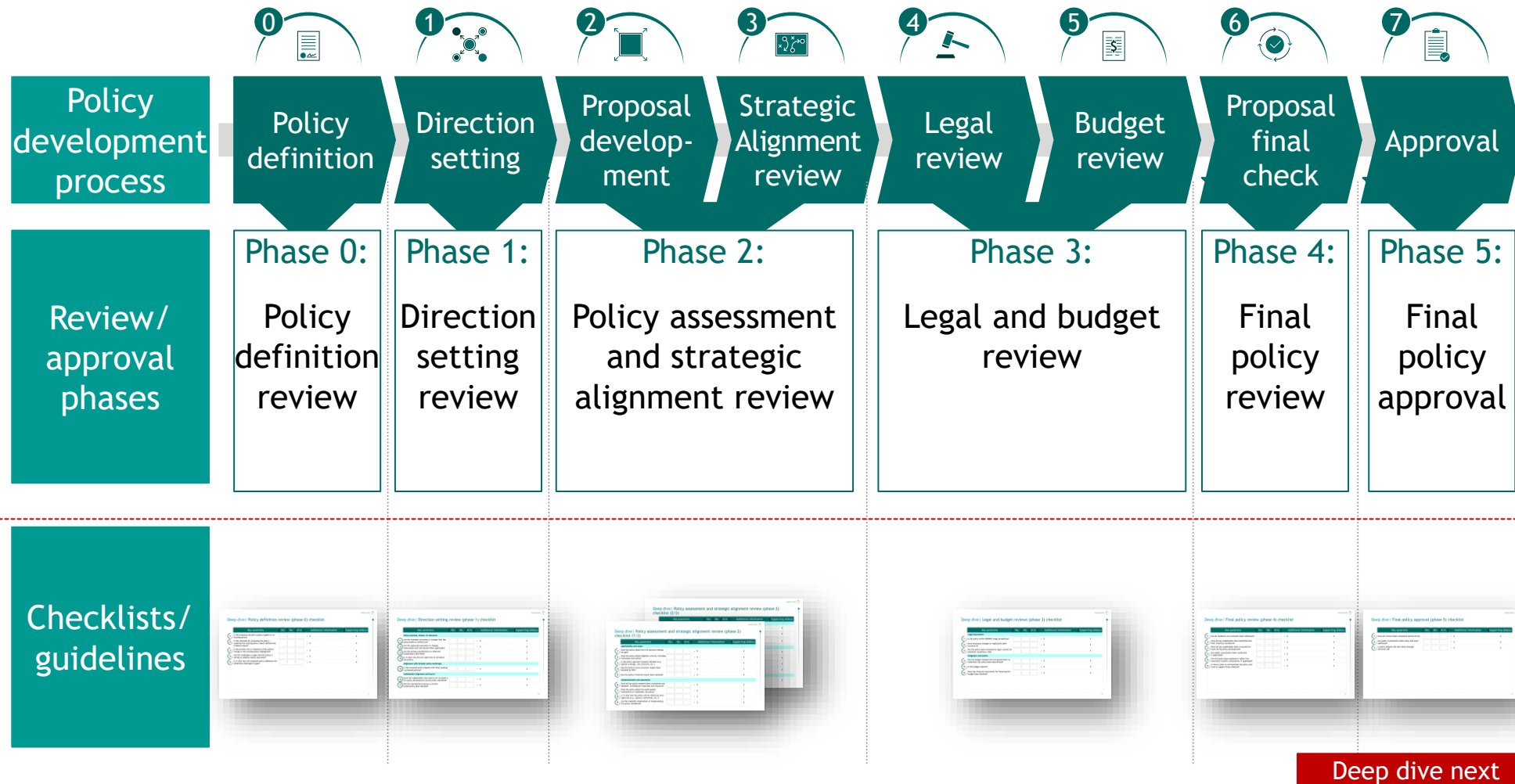


Existing capabilities in various areas of the organization should be leveraged to drive the different steps of policy development



Note: Policy Committee to supervise full process, regardless of step owner

Policy development process should be phased out and supported with detailed checklists / guidelines to ensure proper review and approval



To ensure that policy development efforts are streamlined, each phase should kickstart once the previous phase is completed, reviewed, and approved based on the checklists/ guidelines

Deep dive next

Deep dive | Policy definition review (phase 0) checklist

	Key questions	Yes	No	N/A	Additional information	Supporting slide(s)
1	Does the proposed solution represent a legally binding guiding framework establishing overarching government principles and providing strategic direction / priorities?	☒	☐	☐	• X	X
2	Does the proposed solution need to be approved by the Council of Ministers and ratified by Royal Decree?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
3	Does the proposed solution require to be translated into detailed regulations at a later stage?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
4	Based on the above, is the proposed solution a policy/update to an existing policy?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X

Deep dive | Direction setting review (phase 1) checklist (1/2)

	Key questions	Yes	No	N/A	Additional information	Supporting slide(s)
	Policy purpose, impact, & relevance					
1	Is the rationale for proposing the policy / updating the existing policy clearly defined and evidence-based?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
2	Is the primary aim or objective of the policy/ change to the existing policy highlighted?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
3	Are the challenges or gaps that the policy is aiming to address clearly described?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
4	Is it clear how the proposed policy addresses the identified challenges or gaps?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
5	Are the intended outcomes or changes that the policy seeks to achieve set?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
6	Are the expected outcomes or changes measurable and time-bound where applicable?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
7	Are the primary beneficiaries or affected stakeholders identified?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
8	Is it clear why this the right time to introduce the policy?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X

Deep dive | Direction setting review (phase 1) checklist (2/2)

	Key questions	Yes	No	N/A	Additional information	Supporting slide(s)
	Alignment with broader policy landscape					
9	Is the proposed policy aligned with other existing or planned policies?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
	Stakeholder alignment and buy-in					
10	Have the stakeholders that need to be involved in the policy development process been identified?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
11	Has the mechanism/process to involve stakeholders been detailed?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
12	Is there a need to setup up a specific governance for this policy?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
13	If yes, has the governance been defined?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X

Deep dive| Policy assessment and strategic alignment review (phase 2) checklist (1/2)

	Key questions	Yes	No	N/A	Additional information	Supporting slide(s)
Applicability and scope						
1	Does the policy detail how will decision-making be split?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
2	Does the policy detail eligibility criteria, including exclusions from policy?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
3	Is the policy approach properly detailed (e.g., spatial coverage, rate structure, etc.)	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
4	Has the policy's socio-economic impact been detailed by DSC?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
5	Has the policy's financial impact been detailed if applicable?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
Implementation and operations						
6	Have all key policy enablers been considered and detailed, including pre-requisites and resources?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
7	Does the policy detail the enforcement mechanisms to implement the policy?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
8	Is it clear how the policy will be rolled-out once approved (e.g., phased, nationwide, etc.)?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
9	Are the tradeoffs/implications of implementing the policy considered?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X

Deep dive | Policy assessment and strategic alignment review (phase 2) checklist (2/2)

	Key questions	Yes	No	N/A	Additional information	Supporting slide(s)
Monitoring and adaptation						
10	Does the policy detail which KPIs will be monitored, how often, and by whom?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
11	Does the policy highlight how often will outcomes be disclosed (i.e., to leadership, public, etc.)?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
12	Is the review protocol outlined and detailed (e.g., formal process and timeline to review to rates, eligibility criteria, etc. based on performance)	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
Strategic alignment						
13	Does the policy align with existing national or sectoral strategies (e.g., Vision 2030)?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
14	Is the policy aligned with the Ministry's priorities/ strategic objectives or reform agenda?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
15	Does the policy complement existing policies and programs without causing conflict or duplication?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
16	Is the policy sustainable and adaptable to future changes in context or needs?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
Other						
17	Has the data that was leveraged in the policy been reviewed and validated by DSC?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X

Deep dive | Legal and budget reviews (phase 3) checklist

	Key questions	Yes	No	N/A	Additional information	Supporting slide(s)
	Legal assessment					
1	Is the policy within MOMAH's legal jurisdiction?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
2	Have necessary changes to regulations been factored in?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
3	Has the policy been reviewed and approved by Legal Deputyship?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
	Budgetary assessment					
4	Has the budget needed from the government to implement the policy been determined?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
5	Have the financial instruments for financing the budget been detailed?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X

Deep dive | Final policy review (phase 4) checklist

	Key questions	Yes	No	N/A	Additional information	Supporting slide(s)
1	Have all key stakeholders been consulted for input during policy development?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
2	Has public consultation been conducted, if applicable?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
3	Has the policy been updated to reflect the outcomes of public consultation, if applicable?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
4	Has all feedback and comments been addressed?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
5	Is there a plan to communicate the policy and train or support those affected?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X

Deep dive | Final policy approval (phase 5) checklist

	Key questions	Yes	No	N/A	Additional information	Supporting slide(s)
1	Have all reviews been completed satisfactorily?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
2	Have all identified stakeholders' inputs been taken into account and reflected in the policy?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
3	Has the policy been approved by HEM?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X
4	Has the policy been approved by the governing body, if applicable?	☐	☐	☐	• X	X



Thank you

